2026-04-27

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to recommend Amir Askhatov, a cybersecurity student at James Cook University Singapore, who contributed to an applied security research engagement with Otonata Cybersecurity between February and April 2026.

About the Project

Otonata is a Singapore-based cybersecurity company providing home network security assessments for professionals and small businesses. We partnered with James Cook University in Singapore to bring rigorous, student-led research into real-world vulnerabilities affecting consumer devices - specifically the D-Link DNS-320 NAS, an end-of-life network storage device for which D-Link will issue no further patches.

All work was conducted in a controlled lab environment on equipment owned by our team. The research scope was limited to publicly disclosed CVEs and officially confirmed manufacturer advisories.

Amir's Contribution

Amir was a strong contributor to the investigation of **CVE-2024-3273** — a critical unauthenticated remote command execution vulnerability affecting the D-Link DNS-320, now listed on the CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) catalogue. The vulnerability exploits a backdoor account (`messagebus`) with an empty password, allowing any unauthenticated attacker to execute arbitrary shell commands as root via the device's CGI interface.

To demonstrate the scale of the issue, Amir conducted live Shodan queries to verify whether DNS-320 devices with this vulnerability remain discoverable on the public internet, producing current empirical data to support our educational content.

He further researched online sales platforms to confirm that these products were still being sold second-hand.

Amir approached the work with intellectual curiosity, methodical habits, and a clear understanding of responsible disclosure practices.

I am happy to recommend Amir Askhatov and wish him the best in his career in Cybersecurity.

Yours sincerely,

Joseph Yap

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Managing Director, Otonata Cybersecurity

joseph@otonata.com